

TEAM-Aligned Lesson Plan

U.S. History (Grades 9–12) · Franklin High School · Williamson County Schools

Standard: US.01 — Homestead Act and Transcontinental Railroad

Schedule: Regular block — 47 minutes · Date: _____ · Teacher: _____

TN Standard (full text): *Explain how the Homestead Act and the Transcontinental Railroad impacted the settlement of the West.*

1 · Standards & Objectives

Learning objective (I-CAN): “I can explain how the Homestead Act and the Transcontinental Railroad impacted the settlement of the West, including their effects on American Indians, immigrants, and settlers.”

Sub-objectives (sequenced from the standard's criteria):

- Sequence the expansion of the United States.
- Impact on Western Settlement.
- Impact on American Indians, Immigrants, and Settlers.

Connection to prior learning: Opens the unit — activate prior knowledge from the prior course/unit and preview the arc ahead.

Tennessee connection: George Jordan of Williamson County, Tennessee, was a Buffalo Soldier who received the Medal of Honor for distinguished service during westward expansion.

2 · Assessment & Evidence of Mastery

Measured in multiple ways (TEAM: 3+ measures with clear criteria):

- **Selected-response + short constructed:** US.01 Formative Assessment (with teacher answer key).
- **Extended writing:** CER organizer — claim, evidence, reasoning on the Homestead Act and Transcontinental Railroad.
- **Primary-source analysis:** HIPPO organizer on “Homestead Act” (U.S. Congress, May 20, 1862 (12 Stat. 392)).
- **Exit ticket (EN + ES):** 2-question check for understanding, bilingual.

Success criteria: Student cites at least two specific pieces of evidence and can explain how the Homestead Act and the Transcontinental Railroad impacted the settlement of the West, including their effects on American Indians, immigrants, and settlers.

3 · Lesson Structure & Pacing (47-minute Regular block)

Min	Segment & what happens	Material
5	Warm-Up / Bell-Ringer — activate prior knowledge; frame today's question	Word Bank / Do-Now
4	Hook — George Jordan of Williamson County, Tennessee, was a Buffalo Soldier who received the Medal of Honor for distinguished service during westward expansion: Who gained, who was left out — and why does it still matter?	Teacher Deck
12	Direct Instruction — teacher models close reading of the core content; students capture Cornell Notes	Teacher Deck + Cornell Notes
10	Guided Practice — Cornell Notes + the Geographer's Lens map task (priority — geography is frequently missed on the EOC)	Cornell Notes · Geographer's Lens map
11	Primary Source / HIPPO — analyze the source; begin CER	Primary-Source Packet · HIPPO · CER organizer
5	Exit Ticket & Closure — 2-question check; preview US.02	Exit Ticket (EN/ES)

Total: 47 minutes (segments sum-verified to the block length; auto-adjusts to 43-min Activities or 41-min Late-Start).

4 · Activities & Materials (teacher-selected)

- Cornell Notes (Universal Front) — direct-teaching capture (cue / notes / summary)
- Cornell Support Backs — optional MTSS scaffold; lives in the Teacher Organizer Toolkit, prints duplex behind the Cornell front, copy only as needed

- Comparison / analysis organizer — structure student thinking on the core content
- Primary-Source Packet + HIPPO organizer — sourcing & analysis of “Homestead Act”
- CER organizer — evidence-based extended writing
- Formative Assessment + Exit Ticket (EN/ES) — checks for understanding
- **Geographer's Lens — map task (priority):** locate and explain the places that shaped this standard. Geography is one of the most-missed EOC skills — do not skip it when the standard carries a geographic dimension.

Word Bank (key vocabulary): Homestead Act · Transcontinental Railroad · Westward Expansion · Manifest Destiny · Land Grant · Reservation

Complex text, student choice (organizer format), primary sources, and student-to-student discussion are built in — satisfying the TEAM Activities & Materials indicators.

5 · Questioning Plan (DOK ladder, text-based, cite evidence)

Level	Example question (US.01)
DOK 1	Define the key term “Homestead Act” and identify when it occurred.
DOK 2	In your own words, summarize the Homestead Act and Transcontinental Railroad and explain why it mattered.
DOK 3	Analyze the relationship between the Homestead Act and the decline of American Indian territories. What was the primary cause-and-effect relationship?
DOK 4	Evaluate the long-term impact of the Homestead Act and Transcontinental Railroad — support your claim with evidence from the source(s).

Anchored to the US.01 content and item bank (DOK 1–4). Majority of questions are text-based; students cite evidence. Teacher may swap in additional bank items.

6 · Thinking & Problem-Solving

- **Analytical thinking:** compare and contrast perspectives within the Homestead Act and Transcontinental Railroad.
- **Research-based thinking:** evaluate “Homestead Act” and related sources.
- **Problem-solving (drawing conclusions / justifying):** students build and defend a claim in the CER.

7 · Grouping & Feedback [teacher selects]

- **Grouping:** pairs for the CER organizer; whole-class for the primary-source model; individual exit ticket.
- **Feedback checkpoints:** circulate during Guided Practice and Primary-Source segments; use exit-ticket results to adjust tomorrow's opening.

8 · Differentiation (Knowledge of Students)

- **ELL / WIDA:** UDL/WIDA overlay + sentence frames; Spanish exit ticket for entering/emerging levels.
- **IEP / 504:** chunked Cornell Notes (with the support back), extended time, read-aloud (browser TTS), reduced-item formative option.

9 · Environment Reminders (teacher-implemented)

A lesson plan supports — but cannot manufacture — the TEAM Environment domain. Reminders:

- Set high expectations; frame content with dignity and historical accuracy.
- Establish discussion norms before the primary-source analysis.
- Display current student work; keep materials accessible for the pair activity.

10 · Materials & Where to Print

Included in today's print ZIP (US.01 — print-ready PDF + editable DOCX):

Student (print & copy)	Teacher (your copy)
Vocabulary — Word Bank	Teacher Lesson Plan (this doc)
Vocabulary Studio	Cornell Support Backs — toolkit (copy as needed, MTSS)
Cornell Notes (Universal Front)	Formative Assessment — Answer Key

Student (print & copy)	Teacher (your copy)
Close Read	Primary-Source Teacher Guide
Geographer's Lens — map task	UDL / WIDA overlay
Primary Source / Data Analysis + HIPPO	File Map & Print Guide
Core Application — Practice Quiz	
Constructed Response (CER)	
Exit Ticket — English & Spanish	

Note: students print the Cornell Notes Universal Front. The Cornell Support Backs (Guided/Light scaffolds) live in the Teacher Organizer Toolkit and print duplex on the reverse — copy them only for students who need them (MTSS), and fade as evidence grows.

Slides (download once for the unit):

Unit 1 Teacher Deck — US.01 slides. Download from Teacher Tools → Lecture Decks → Unit 1. (Decks are reused all unit, so they are not bundled in the daily ZIP.)

11 · Reflection & Next Steps

Teacher reflection (complete after teaching):

- Did students meet the I-CAN? Cite the evidence — exit-ticket % correct, CER quality.
- What worked, and what would I change next time?
- Which sub-objective still needs another touch tomorrow?

Extension / enrichment (for students who mastered it):

- Deeper source work: analyze a second primary source with the HIPPO organizer.
- Connect forward: how does the Homestead Act and Transcontinental Railroad set up US.02 (Federal Policies Toward American Indians)?

If it's not working (reteach / intervention path):

- Below ~70% mastery on the exit ticket / formative → reteach with entry-tier materials (Cornell Notes + the Cornell Support Back + a shorter source) in a small group — MTSS Tier 2.
- **One click — “Remediate US.01”:** assembles a reteach pack (entry-tier worksheet, targeted DOK 1–2 questions, ELL/IEP supports) as a fresh print ZIP.
- **Mid-lesson trouble:** if pacing slips, protect the 5-min Exit Ticket — it's tomorrow's data — and move the CER to homework or the next day.

Appendix · How this plan maps to the TEAM rubric

TEAM indicator	Where addressed
Standards & Objectives	§1 — I-CAN + sequenced sub-objectives + prior learning
Motivating Students	§3 Hook — Tennessee relevance
Presenting Content	§3 DI — deck visuals + Cornell Notes + modeling
Lesson Structure & Pacing	§3 — 47-min segmented, warm-up → closure
Activities & Materials	§4 — varied, choice, primary sources, complex text
Questioning	§5 — DOK 1–4 ladder, text-based, cite evidence
Feedback	§7 — checkpoints during guided practice
Grouping	§7 — pairs + whole-class + individual
Teacher Content Knowledge	§1/§4 — accurate, standards-aligned content
Knowledge of Students	§8 — UDL/WIDA + IEP/504
Thinking / Problem-Solving	§6 — analytical, research-based, justify a claim
PLANNING: Instructional Plans	Whole plan — sequenced, accommodations, closure
PLANNING: Student Work	§2 — CER + HIPPO extended writing
PLANNING: Assessment	§2 — multiple measures + clear criteria
Environment (3 indicators)	§9 — reminders (teacher-implemented; not auto-generated)

The three PLANNING indicators (highlighted) are what a written plan is directly scored on — this template earns them structurally. The Instruction indicators are documented so the teacher walks in ready; the Environment domain is prompted, not generated.